proposition that can be expressed in different sentences. 'The man cuts the wood with an axe' and 'The wood is cut by the man with an axe' have the same *karaka*-structure. The *karakas* are:

Karta: the agent. This is independent relative to the other aspects of the action.
Karman: what the agent most desires is called 'object'.
Apadanam: that which is the fixed point of departure is called 'starting point'.
Sampradanam: that which one aims at as the object of one's action is called 'recipient'.
Karanam: that which is most effective is called 'instrument'.
Adhikaranam: substratum is called 'locus'.

There is a verse, 'The master of the factors in relation to action and inaction, whether it is currently active or not, is the factor called the agent.' Which means that conscious selves, enduring through time, are responsible for their moral and ritual actions. In events involving human actions, the selves are what hold together a sequence of fleeting events as a causal process and underpin continuities. The stable and enduring ***atman***, which is given in experience but not produced by it, is undetermined by space and time.

See ***Karana-vada***

Karana (cause according to ***Nyaya-Vaisheshika***): cause is what *invariably* occurs *before* the effect. It is an indispensable prior condition. Cause and effect are distinct entities. The effect is called the counter-positive (***pratiyogin***) of its own prior absence. It originates as a novel product. It did not pre-exist in a potential state.